

Meeting Minutes

Lalitpur HRRP Coordination Meeting

Date: 17 03 16

Time: 2:00 pm

Location: Sainbu

Lead/Chairperson/Focal Point: Rohit Raj Pokhrel

Participants: Bungamati reconstruction committee, Karyabinayak Municipality (Ka.Bi.NP)

Agendas:

1. Welcome
2. Introduction
3. HRRP: Brief Introduction, objectives & activities
4. Key remarks by Executive Officer, Karyabinayak Municipality
5. Agency Updates- Housing Recovery & Reconstruction Activities
6. Open discussion
 - 6.1. Communities concerns/limitations on the reconstruction of the housing
 - 6.2. Urban issues on the reconstruction process
7. AOB

1. Welcome

Shubha Amatya Khadka, an engineer from municipality, started the program with a welcome speech.

2. Introduction

All the participants of the meeting self introduced themselves.

3. HRRP: Brief Introduction, objectives & activities

The Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform District coordinator, Binita Shrestha, presented about objectives, role and responsibilities of HRRP. She elaborated that HRRP is working for coordination, strategic planning and technical guidance to agencies involved in recovery and reconstruction, and to support the Government of Nepal in coordinating the national reconstruction programme.

4. Key remarks by Executive Officer

Mr. Rohit Raj Pokharel, executive officer, informed about the pilot reconstruction project has been started from Bungamati. He further explained that the municipality with the help of Central Bureau of Statistics has been mobilizing the engineers, social mobilizers and other staffs for data collection about the problems the earthquake victims are facing, expected reconstruction plans and technologies, by door to door census. He told that after a report of the data collection process, the municipality can do some planning or assist in the reconstruction works. He informed that the municipality has decided to offer 50% discount on building permit for the earthquake victims. He stated that the current building by-laws are impractical for the reconstruction of the dense core

areas. So he stated that a special by-laws is necessary for the core areas and the municipality is exercising on it with the meetings of the stakeholders. He said that NSET is working on the reconstruction process for Khokana and UN-Habitat is working on Bungamati. He further told that the house pooling concept should be executed in such a way that it fulfils all the needs and expectation of the communities and different awareness raising programs, presentations has been conducted from time to time in these localities.

5. Updates from the Community - Housing Recovery & Reconstruction Activities

Mr. Prem Bhakta Maharjan, Secretary from Bungamati Reconstruction Committee, informed that a reconstruction committee was formed with his coordination among the 19 members. He stated that about 853 houses have been affected due to earthquake in Bungamati. He elaborated that Bungamati consists of three types of settlements, historically important settlement, highland (ward no. 11, 13) and Tamang basti (ward no.9). He stated about the master plan of reconstructing the core areas of Bungamati as a tourism point of view and UN-Habitat and NSET has been assisting in this process. He said the community people want to protect the cultural and traditional values along with the reconstruction process. This process will boost the economic status of the people. But the reconstruction of buildings in traditional designs will be expensive. Hence, the reconstruction grant of 2 lakhs will not be sufficient and the NRA should formulate some policies to provide some incentives/ subsidy for the reconstruction of buildings in traditional design in order to promote these types of building construction. He told that the reconstruction works is impossible for the core areas with the implementation of recently revised building by-laws. So, different building bye-laws, for these core areas, should be developed with the authority of the municipality and community. He informed that the community is going to establish the Bungamati Reconstruction Trust chaired by the Executive officer, Karyabinayak Municipality.

Mr. Ganga Lal Dangol, ward secretary of ward no. 6,7,8,9, highlighted about the work plans of “Khokana Earthquake reconstruction committee” and “Khokana Recovery and Reconstruction Committee” in reconstruction sector. He informed about the ongoing data collection process in Khokana. He said about 900 houses don't have land ownership, but they could access the building permit through the recommendation by ward office. He elaborated the necessity of the land survey for the reconstruction works.

We came know from ward secretary, Surendra thapa magar, to found there's less destruction in Sainbu as compared to other wards in municipality. Around 25 sheds are destroyed in that locality. Some of the wards (eg: dukuchhap) are still fighting for the shelter and others basic needs where there has been full damage of houses and no organization has visited till now. After earthquake, many people died because of winter problems too.

6. Open Discussion:

6.1. Communities concerns/limitations on the reconstruction of the housing

6.2. Urban issues on the reconstruction process

The peoples are concerned about the policies of reconstruction process. They want to develop their community as a historically and culturally significant place and want to promote tourism in their communities. So they are concerned about the reconstruction process in the core areas. They figured out the necessity of subsidy for promoting the traditional designs in the reconstruction of historically important settlements. The community

peoples informed about the necessity of the government concern in the remote areas of the municipality as the government is focusing the reconstruction works of Bungamati and Khokana only. They are feeling sad that the government is acting very slowly in reconstruction and recently the government has stopped all the ongoing reconstruction works by INGOs and NGOs.

Ward number 17 and 18 is one of the remote areas of this municipality and about 606 houses are completely affected by the earthquake. Till now there is no reach of any agencies for the rescue and reconstruction works in this area. There is no record of temporary shelter construction in this area. People are self constructing their shelters. Similar to Bungamati and Khokana, this village also holds some culturally important sites and this area also needs reconstruction emphasizing these factors. Moreover, the community people, here, are economically very weak and they are still living in their vulnerable temporary shelters.

Action Points

1. The municipality is ready for the proper reconstruction planning after the completion of data collection process.
2. The municipality is going to address the need and necessity of community for the reconstruction process and municipality is working out to conserve the traditional and cultural values of Bungamati and Khokana for the promotion of tourism in these settlements.

Next Meeting

The next _meeting will be held on _from_ in . Led by _ , can be contacted by Binita shrestha; District Coordinator.

Meeting Participants List/Attendance Sheet

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